

ttaro-ttaro — Split Bill AI Agent

github.com/juliaisalina/ttaro-ttaro · ttaro-ttaro.vercel.app · [Notion: Further description](#)

WHY I PICKED THIS MOMENT

In Korean, people say **ttaro-ttaro**. In Japanese, **betsu-betsu**. In Malay, *asing-asing*. In Mandarin, **AA zhi**. In Hindi, *paadhi paadhi*. Almost every culture has its own way of saying “split separately,” which shows that shared expenses are universal, but still socially awkward.

I focused on **group trips and outings** because this is when the problem becomes dense. One person books the hotel, another pays for dinner, someone else covers transport, and small cafe or ticket expenses pile up throughout the day. The broken moment is not just splitting costs. It is when the person who pays first becomes the unofficial expense manager, responsible for remembering, calculating, and following up without making the friendship uncomfortable.

The idea was inspired by Apple’s proactive password detection in Messages: it notices useful information before the user manually searches for it. I wanted to explore whether shared expense management could work the same way.

WHO THIS IS FOR

This is for **small social groups who frequently share expenses during trips, outings, or temporary group activities**: travelling friends, exchange students, event committees, club members, or roommates sharing occasional costs.

The main user is the person who usually pays first and manages the money afterwards. They are not bad at organizing; they are stuck doing unpaid coordination work inside a social situation where asking for repayment can feel petty.

PAIN POINT AND CURRENT WORKAROUNDS

The first pain point is the **manual tracking burden**. People have to switch between payment apps and expense apps, remember who participated, enter amounts repeatedly, categorize costs, and often forget smaller expenses until later.

The second pain point is the **social discomfort of repayment**. People delay asking for money, avoid asking completely, or feel awkward sending reminders. Over time, unpaid balances can create resentment.

Current workarounds such as group chats, notes, spreadsheets, Splitwise, N-bbang, and payment apps help with parts of the problem, but they still require users to manually enter expenses, manually choose participants, manually settle outside the app, and manually check who has paid. They track the debt, but they do not remove the coordination work.

In short, Splitwise and N-bbang mainly help users record and calculate. **ttaro-ttaro** explores whether a proactive helper can **track, understand, remind, settle, and coordinate repayment** with user approval.

HOW THE PROTOTYPE ADDRESSES THE PAIN POINT

ttaro-ttaro uses *Taro* as a split bill helper. Taro detects possible shared expenses from mock wallet transactions, uses mock group chats, booking emails, and call transcripts as context, suggests who should be included, explains why someone owes a certain amount, drafts polite repayment reminders, and simulates wallet-to-wallet settlement after approval.

For example, if Julia pays **50,000 KRW** at a cafe and Taro detects that normal cafe spending is closer to **10,000 KRW per person**, it suggests that this may be a shared expense. The user reviews the participants, split amount, and wallet transfers before approving. Taro never moves money or sends reminders without explicit confirmation.

The current prototype is frontend-only with no database and no real AI implementation. Wallet transactions, chats, emails, call transcripts, reminders, and settlements are simulated with mock data. I built it using Claude Code, connected it to GitHub, and deployed it on Vercel. This was my first time using Claude Code; it was not completely easy, but it was intuitive enough to build quickly under limited time. I used LLMs to organize my brainstorm into clearer flows, then focused on a working prototype instead of a static mockup.

WHAT I WOULD TEST FIRST

Core question: Are manual expense tracking and repayment reminders frustrating enough that people would genuinely want this kind of helper involved?

I would talk to people who recently shared costs on a trip or outing and ask: (1) How do you currently manage shared expenses? (2) Who becomes the tracker in your group? (3) Have you ever avoided asking someone to repay you because it felt awkward? (4) Which part would you most want to disappear: recording, calculating, reminding, or checking repayment?

Success signal: people recall specific uncomfortable moments, such as chasing friends after a trip, absorbing costs to avoid conflict, or dreading repayment reminders. **Pivot signal:** users find the concept interesting but cannot remember a time the pain was actually real.